



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bradford Academy

School Website: <https://bradfordacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Bishop Ryan Catholic School — Classicality Audit

Website used: <https://bishopryan.com>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Why: Bishop Ryan publicly centers its mission on “education in virtue,” explicitly grounding education in theology, liturgy, and the formation of the whole person. The site highlights daily prayer, the opportunity to attend daily Mass, religion classes, retreats, service, and celebrations throughout the liturgical year, all of which align strongly with the “Religious & Metaphysical Foundations” and “Purpose & Goal” elements of classical education as defined in our Six Elements framework and lexicon (Mass, prayer, liturgy, virtue, formation). The school also states it adopted a “classically rooted educational plan” in 2018, signaling intent and orientation.

What's missing: The public materials currently do not document the classical liberal arts curriculum (Trivium/Quadrivium), Great Books/primary texts, Latin requirements, or Socratic pedagogy. Instead, we see typical modern markers (e.g., “Advanced Placement opportunities”), which weakly signal a conventional college-prep posture in pedagogy rather than distinctly classical methods like Socratic seminars, chanting/memorization, or scholé/restful learning. Faculty formation and a public portrait of a teacher are also not described.

Net: Strong theological and virtue-first identity with community and liturgical life; insufficient publicly visible evidence of classical curriculum and pedagogy.

How to Read This Audit

Per instructions, we evaluate six categories using the positive/negative keyword indicators from the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” and the classicality lexicon, then assign category ratings and an aggregate classification. Representative positive indicators include truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Socratic/seminar, chanting/memorization, scholé/rest; negatives include progressive/skills-first framing, project-based dominance, STEM-first framing, and college-and-career ready emphasis absent formation language.

For each category we: 1) Identify keywords found on Bishop Ryan's site. 2) Compare with the positive/negative lists. 3) Quantify positive vs. negative signals and coverage. 4) Assign a rating.

CATEGORY 1: Religious & Metaphysical Foundations

- What we found on the site (direct terms/phrases):
 - “Daily Prayer,” “opportunity to attend daily Mass,” “Religion classes,” “Retreats,” “Special celebrations throughout the liturgical year”
 - Mission: “To serve God and His children... through education in virtue” (extended mission text cites Catechism, St. Augustine, and adheres “to the truth”)
- Lexicon alignment (positives): theology (Catechism), liturgy/Mass/prayer, virtue/formation, truth; all are core positive signals for this category .
- Negative indicators: none evident.

Quantified keyword snapshot: - Positive hits: 10 (serve God, prayer, Mass, religion, retreats, liturgical year, virtue, Catechism quotes, St. Augustine, truth) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Percent coverage: 0.90 Rating: CLASSICAL

Why: Bishop Ryan explicitly integrates worship and theological formation into daily school life, which the framework identifies as classical hallmarks (liturgy, worship, Mass, prayer, catechesis) .

CATEGORY 2: School Purpose & Goal

- What we found:
 - Mission: “education in virtue,” “directing their lives toward God by knowing, loving, and serving Him,” aiming at “lasting happiness” (telos) .
 - Three-fold formative approach (human, religious, intellectual) and explicit partnership with parents
- Lexicon alignment (positives): formation, virtue/wisdom, telos/true-good-beautiful orientation (expressed as “lasting happiness in God”) .
- Negative indicators: The site does not foreground “college and career readiness” or “21st-century skills” language here; “AP” appears but pertains more to pedagogy than to stated telos.

Quantified keyword snapshot: - Positive hits: 6 (virtue, formation, knowing-loving-serving God, telos of happiness in God, discipleship, partnership with parents) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 0.95 - Percent coverage: 0.85 Rating: CLASSICAL

Why: Bishop Ryan’s stated aim is formation toward virtue and God—precisely the classical purpose (formation > information; wisdom and virtue > credentialing) .

CATEGORY 3: Curriculum

- What we found:
 - “Classically rooted educational plan, formally adopted in 2018” .
 - “Religion classes” noted among academics and formation activities, but no public detail on the liberal arts (Trivium/Quadrivium), Great Books/primary texts, Latin/Greek requirements, or “history (not social studies)” naming .
- Lexicon alignment (positives): We do not see explicit Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/primary sources, or Latin—strong positives expected in a classical curriculum .
- Negative indicators: Not seeing overt “project-based only,” STEM-first, or “social studies” replacing “history,” but “AP opportunities” point to conventional college-prep sequencing rather than classical scaffolding (weak negative signal, stronger under pedagogy/rest rather than curricular content) .

Quantified keyword snapshot: - Positive hits: 1 (“classically rooted” orientation statement) - Negative hits: 0 (no clear curricular negatives captured) - Percent positive: 0.10 - Percent coverage: 0.20 Rating: NOT

CLASSICAL

Why: The site does not (yet) document the classical curricular pillars (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin/Greek, Great Conversation) expected by the framework .

CATEGORY 4: Pedagogy (Teaching Methods)

- What we found:
 - No public mention of Socratic seminar/dialectic, chanting/recitation, progymnasmata/imitation, or scholé/restful learning.
 - “Advanced Placement opportunities” appears (college-prep marker), which aligns with negative indicators that emphasize AP-heavy, performance-driven approaches over restful formation if overused or centered as a goal .
- Lexicon alignment (positives): absent (Socratic, chanting, memorization, scholé, rhetoric orations) .
- Negative indicators: college-prep/AP emphasis appears as a restfulness negative, not determinative but noteworthy .

Quantified keyword snapshot: - Positive hits: 0 - Negative hits: 1 (AP/college-prep signal under restful-learning negatives) - Percent positive: 0.00 - Percent coverage: 0.15 Rating: NOT CLASSICAL

Why: The distinctive classical pedagogies are not publicly described; one mild negative marker appears.

CATEGORY 5: Faculty

- What we found:
 - Faculty directory exists, but public pages do not present a “portrait of a teacher,” faculty as “living curriculum,” or teachers as mentors/modelers of virtue; only a generic “Dedicated teachers” note appears .
- Lexicon alignment (positives): weak; classical schools typically foreground teachers as mentors, exemplars, collegial “faculty of friends,” and their classical formation .
- Negative indicators: none explicit.

Quantified keyword snapshot: - Positive hits: 1 (“Dedicated teachers” as a weak proxy) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 0.20 - Percent coverage: 0.20 Rating: NOT CLASSICAL

Why: Insufficient evidence of a classical faculty vision or formation in the public materials.

CATEGORY 6: Parents & Community

- What we found:
 - “Bishop Ryan ... works with parents and the Church to raise children in the faith...” (explicit parent partnership) .
 - Community/liturgical life: service projects for all grades, celebrations throughout the liturgical year; “Super Omnia” fosters community support for mission .
- Lexicon alignment (positives): partnership with parents; community life around liturgical year; service and hospitality align with the Community element .
- Negative indicators: no sign of “parent-as-customer only.” The site does not (yet) show public parent formation (book groups/seminars).

Quantified keyword snapshot: - Positive hits: 4 (partners with parents, works with Church, liturgical year events, service community) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 0.80 - Percent coverage: 0.60 Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Why: Good partnership/community signals; parent formation could be made more explicit.

Aggregate Judgment

- Category ratings:
 - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
 - Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL
 - Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL
 - Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
 - Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL
 - Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school's visible identity is strongly theological, liturgical, and virtue-focused—excellent classical foundations (and it explicitly calls its plan “classically rooted” since 2018). However, public documentation does not yet evidence the hallmark curricular and pedagogical features (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/primary texts, Latin & rhetoric sequences, Socratic/seminar practices, memory work/chant, scholé) that would justify a full “CLASSICAL” rating at this time .

“What would move the needle” (to reach CLASSICAL)

Concrete, public-facing steps: 1) Publish a classical curriculum map: - Name the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as organizing arts; show where each is taught and how it shapes instruction and assessment K–12 . - Publish Great Books/primary source reading lists by grade; emphasize the Great Conversation across humanities and sciences . - Clarify classical languages (Latin/Greek): scope/sequence, aims, and rationale .

2) Describe classical pedagogy in action:

- Socratic/seminar in upper grades; narration/recitation/chanting in lower grades; progymnasmata & imitation in writing; rhetoric orations/capstone; debate/oratory strands .
- Explain scholé/restful learning (depth over pace; multum non multa) and how AP (if retained) is subordinated to formation, not the driver .

3) Faculty formation and “portrait”:

- Publish a Portrait of a Teacher and outline faculty formation in classical pedagogy; underscore teachers as mentors/models of virtue and the “living curriculum” .

4) Parent formation:

- Publicize parent book clubs/seminars on classical education and household liturgical alignment; emphasize parents as co-educators .
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Evidence Highlights (select citations)

- Mission and virtue emphasis; extended mission/catechetical framing, “education in virtue,” “knowing, loving, serving God,” “adheres to the truth” .
 - Daily prayer, daily Mass opportunity, religion classes, retreats, liturgical year celebrations .
 - “Classically rooted educational plan, formally adopted in 2018” .
 - Partnership with parents and the Church; community support via “Super Omnia” .
 - Tagline: “Inspired Minds. Faithful Hearts. Lives of Virtue.” .
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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